A FREE GUIDE BY SERGIO VEGA

4 silent ways Spanish electricity companies overcharge expats.

A 10-minute audit guide based on real bills, from a Costa Blanca-based advisor who got tired of seeing the same patterns.

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INTRODUCTION

Why I made this guide.

I'm Sergio, based on the Costa Blanca. Two years ago I started looking at my father's electricity bill — Iberdrola customer, retired, living in a small place in Elche. I found a charge of €8.08 every month for something called "Protección 360" that he had never signed up for. €113 quietly gone in just over a year.

Then I checked my neighbour's bill. Same pattern. Then a few friends. Same pattern again.

After looking at dozens of bills from British, Dutch, and German expats living in Costa Blanca, I noticed the same 4 things kept coming up. Not always all four. Often two or three. But the pattern was consistent enough to be predictable.

This guide explains what those 4 patterns are, how to spot them on your own bill in about 10 minutes, and what to do about each one.

It is free. There is nothing to buy here. If, after reading it, you'd like me to take a look at your specific bill, you can reply to one of my emails with a photo. I'll tell you what I see, in plain English. If your bill is fine, I'll tell you that too. Some of my audits end exactly like that — "adjust one thing, stay put" — and when that's the verdict, that's what you get in writing.

— Sergio Vega

Asesor energético · Costa Blanca

THE DOCTRINE

The 4 patterns.

If your Spanish electricity bill is overcharging you, it's probably doing it in one (or more) of these four ways. After the next pages I show you each one in detail, with a real case.

01

Hidden line items

A monthly charge for a "Pack", "Protection" or "Smart Solar" service you don't remember signing up for. Fixed amount, marketing name.

02

Inflated kWh price

Your energy price is 50-100% above the current market average — locked into a "Plan Estable" or similar fixed-rate trap.

03

Time-of-use tariff wasted

You have a 2.0TD tariff with peak/valley pricing, but you're being billed at one flat rate. You pay for the structure, you don't use it.

04

Wrong power capacity

Either over-contracted (paying for power you never use) or under-contracted (your meter trips at peak demand).

A good bill checks all four. Most overcharge cases involve at least two patterns running at the same time.

PATTERN 01

Hidden line items.

The single most common overcharge I find. And the easiest to fix.

Look at your bill. Find the section called "Servicios y otros conceptos" or "Other services and concepts".

If there is anything in there beyond "Alquiler del contador" (the meter rental — small, ~€0.80/month, normal) — you're likely paying for a service you didn't ask for.

The most common names I've seen on actual bills:

- "Protección Eléctrica Hogar" or "Pack Protección" (Iberdrola)
- "Pack Iberdrola" — sometimes hidden inside the bill detail
- "Smart Solar" — if you don't have solar panels installed
- "Mantenimiento del Hogar" — repair service you may never use
- "Hogar 24" or similar 24/7 emergency packs

HOW TO SPOT IT

1. They appear as a fixed monthly amount (€5-15), not linked to consumption.
2. The name is marketing, not electricity: "Protección", "Pack", "Hogar", "Smart".
3. The line sits under "Servicios y otros conceptos", not under energy.

PATTERN 01 · REAL CASE

Antonio's bill.

A retired man living alone in a small country house in Elche (Costa Blanca). Iberdrola customer for 11 years. He was paying €78.30/month — felt high for someone who barely used electricity, but assumed that was normal.

> *I never signed up for that. I would remember.*

What we found when we opened the bill:

- A line called "Protección 360" — €8.08/month. Fixed, every single month.
- On the bill for 14 months. Total quietly gone: €113.
- kWh price 0.159 €/kWh — about 40% above market.
- Plan Estable tariff — flat rate billing on a 2.0TD meter.

MONTHLY BEFORE	MONTHLY AFTER	ANNUAL SAVING
€78.30	**€57.28**	**€252**
Iberdrola Plan Estable	competitive switch	and Protección 360 cancelled

Antonio asked for the Protección line to be cancelled — we made sure it was confirmed in writing and stayed cancelled — switched to a fairer tariff, and stopped paying €252/year for nothing.

PATTERN 02

Inflated kWh price.

If your bill says "Plan Estable" or "Plan A Tu Medida" at the top, this concerns you.

Spanish electricity has two price systems:

1. Regulated tariff (PVPC): the price moves daily with the wholesale market — and it has spent most of recent years well below what the big fixed plans charge.

2. Free market tariff: any price the supplier sets. Could be €0.10. Could be €0.22. Could be anywhere in between.

Many expats end up on "Plan Estable" or similar fixed-rate tariffs from Iberdrola, Endesa, Naturgy or Repsol. Sometimes signed up by phone, sometimes inherited from the previous tenant. They lock you in at €0.18 to €0.22 / kWh — comfortable for the supplier, expensive for you.

HOW TO SPOT IT

1. Find the line "Energía consumida" or "Energy consumed".
2. Look at the €/kWh price. If it's above €0.15, you're paying a premium.
3. If it's above €0.20, you're paying nearly double the market.

PATTERN 02 · REAL CASE

Ricardo's bill.

A retiree, Iberdrola customer with a "Plan Estable" contract. Low consumption — about 4.6 kWh per day. He thought his bill was small enough not to worry about. We checked anyway.

Three things we found on a 30-day bill:

- kWh price: €0.218 — almost double the market at the time.
- A "Pack Iberdrola" line: €8.65/month, every month. €104/year gone.
- Power under-contracted: 3.45 kW contracted, 4.32 kW peak demand. Lights trip.

WE COMPARED HIS BILL AGAINST 25 ALTERNATIVE TARIFFS

All 25 were cheaper than his current Iberdrola plan.

Best option: an indexed tariff saving €22.80/month — a 36% reduction.

Worst alternative still saved €4.64/month. Every single one was better.

MONTHLY BEFORE	MONTHLY AFTER	ANNUAL SAVING
€62.81	**€40.01**	**€274**
Plan Estable	indexed tariff	and Pack Iberdrola cancelled

PATTERN 03

Time-of-use wasted.

You pay for a tariff structure. You never use it.

Since 2021, all Spanish residential meters use the 2.0TD tariff structure, which has three different prices per kWh depending on the hour:

- Peak (Punta) — 10:00-14:00 and 18:00-22:00 weekdays. Most expensive.
- Off-peak (Llano) — middle of the day. Medium price.
- Valley (Valle) — overnight, weekends and holidays. Cheapest.

If you don't shift any consumption to off-peak hours — washing machines, dishwashers, charging the electric car overnight, heating water at night — you're paying premium-hour prices the entire day.

Even worse: some "Plan Estable" tariffs charge you ONE flat rate as if the time-of-use structure didn't exist. You pay for the meter, you pay for the categories on the bill, but you get nothing back from them.

Compare to your neighbour on PVPC who runs the dishwasher at 2am: same meter, same usage, much smaller bill.

PATTERN 04

Wrong power capacity.

The mistake goes both ways: too much and too little are both expensive.

Spanish electricity bills charge you for two things: the energy you use (kWh) AND the power capacity reserved for you (kW).

Power capacity is a fixed monthly cost. You pay for it whether you use it or not. Too much = you pay for nothing. Too little = your meter trips every time you turn on the oven and the AC at the same time.

The 2.0TD tariff splits this into two power values: P1 (peak hours) and P2 (off-peak hours). Many bills set both at the same value — which often means at least one of them is wrong.

HOW TO CHECK

1. Find on your bill: "Potencia contratada" P1 and P2 (in kW).
2. Find: "Potencia máxima demandada" or "Maximum demand last 12 months".
3. If maximum demand is much LOWER than contracted: you're over-contracted.
4. If maximum demand is HIGHER than contracted: you're under-contracted (the meter usually trips at peak load, lights go off briefly).

PATTERN 04 · REAL CASE · HONESTY

The case we told NOT to switch.

A self-employed couple in Costa Blanca with rooftop solar panels installed. Iberdrola customer. They asked us to audit their bill — they had a feeling something was off.

What we did:
We compared their bill against 25 alternative tariffs from 5 different providers (NIBA, Gana Energia, Repsol, Endesa, Naturgy, Iberdrola). None of them would save them money.

> *Don't switch. Your current bill is fine.*

But we did find something a comparison website never will:

- Their off-peak power (P2): 3.45 kW contracted.
- Actual maximum demand during off-peak hours: 0.00 kW (the solar covers everything).
- They were paying ~€60/year for off-peak power capacity they never use.

We told them: don't switch — one number in your contract is wrong, and we'll fix it with you. A 10-minute adjustment, no tariff change, no provider change, and around €50/year stopped leaking. That audit earned us nothing. It's still our favourite kind.

THE LESSON

Some of my audits end exactly like this — no switch, just a small adjustment. When that's the verdict, that's what you get in writing.

THE CHECKLIST

10-minute self-audit.

Get your most recent electricity bill in front of you. Work through these checks. If any one of them flags, your bill is probably overcharging you.

01 · Servicios y otros conceptos

Anything beyond the meter rental? Note the name and the amount. Marketing names — "Protección", "Pack", "Hogar", "Smart" — are the flag.

02 · Energía consumida

Find the €/kWh. Above €0.15 = premium. Above €0.20 = nearly double market.

03 · Tarifa de acceso

Does it say 2.0TD? Are there 3 columns of prices (Punta / Llano / Valle)? If yes, are you actually shifting any usage to Valle?

04 · Potencia contratada

Find P1 and P2 in kW. Find "máxima demandada" in the last 12 months. Is one much higher or much lower than the other?

05 · Plan name

Top of the bill: "Plan Estable", "Plan A Tu Medida", "Plan Confort"? Those are fixed-rate flags.

06 · Provider compensation if solar

If you have solar panels: what € per kWh do they pay you for exports? Below €0.08 = below market.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Sergio Vega.

I'm Sergio, based in Alicante, on the Costa Blanca. I've been working with British, Dutch and German expats here for years, reading contracts and paperwork line by line.

The energy advisory side started accidentally. A few clients asked me "can you take a look at my electricity bill?" and the patterns I saw were so consistent that I decided to make it a free service.

I work in English and Spanish. The audit costs you nothing — there is no service fee, no commitment, no commission from you. If we switch you to another provider, the new provider pays me a small commission. If we don't switch you, you still get an honest report, and I move on. Some of my audits end with "don't change anything" — a real answer, in writing.

If you'd like me to look at yours, just reply to the next email I send you with a photo of your last bill. I'll get back to you within one working day.

Contact

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WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Over the next 2 weeks.

You'll get 5 short emails from me over the next two weeks. One every 2-3 days. Each one goes deeper into one of the patterns above, with a real bill example and what to do about it.

Email 1	Pattern 01 deep dive: how these charges work, how to spot them, and how we get them removed — for good.
Email 2	Pattern 02 deep dive: how to read the kWh price, market benchmarks, and when switching is worth it.
Email 3	Pattern 03 deep dive: time-of-use tariffs explained with examples — appliance by appliance.
Email 4	Pattern 04 deep dive: power capacity — the two numbers on your bill that settle it.
Email 5	If you want, send me a photo of your last bill. I'll audit it within one working day, in plain English.

And after the series? I keep writing — one short note a day, real bills and real cases from this coast, a two-minute read. If it's not for you, one click unsubscribes you from everything.

REMEMBER

You can unsubscribe at any time, and I never share your details with anyone. No spam. No sharing. No pressure.

FREE AUDIT · NO COMMITMENT

When you're ready — send a photo.

Front page of your last electricity bill is enough. WhatsApp or email. I'll get back to you in plain English within one working day. Some of my audits end with 'don't change anything' — and that's a real answer too.

WHATSAPP

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Photo of your bill. That's it.

EMAIL

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Attach a photo of your bill.

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All case studies in this guide are based on real bills, anonymised. Cases are individual — your results may differ. The audit is provided free as a service to help you understand your bill; there is no obligation to switch providers.